

Absolutely — **indicate** is a very strong polysemy/family target because your passage uses it here:

> “Although research **indicates that** electric vehicles are greener than petrol cars...”

Here **indicates that** means **shows or suggests, on the basis of evidence, that something is probably true**.

Word family: **indicate / indication / indicator / indicative / indicatively**

Base verb: indicate

Noun: indication

Noun: indicator

Adjective: indicative

Adverb: indicatively (rare / specialist)

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞) / adjective (形容詞)

Major domains:

- * evidence and research
- * signs/symptoms
- * pointing/showing direction
- * instruments and displays
- * signalling intention
- * driving/turn signals
- * mentioning/specifying
- * measurement and statistics
- * economics/business indicators
- * medicine
- * grammar/linguistics through **indicative**
- * formal instructions/forms

Meaning in your passage: **indicate that** = show/suggest from evidence that — 顯示；表明；指出.....很可能是真的

Your sentence:

> “research **indicates that** electric vehicles are greener than petrol cars”

means:

> **research evidence suggests or shows that electric vehicles are greener than petrol cars.**

****繁體中文：****

****研究結果 / 證據顯示、表明某個結論很可能成立****

Natural translation:

> 「雖然研究****顯示****，電動車比汽油車更環保……」

So here:

> ****indicate = 根據證據、數據或跡象顯示某事，而不是單純口頭說出某事****

A. EVIDENCE / RESEARCH

1. ****indicate that + clause = 顯示；表明****

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Research ****indicates that**** electric vehicles are greener than petrol cars.”

「研究****顯示****電動車比汽油車更環保。」

Practice 2

> “The results ****indicate that**** demand is rising.”

「結果****顯示****需求正在上升。」

****indicate that X = 證據 / 結果 / 情況顯示 X 很可能成立****

2. ****evidence indicates + noun/clause = 證據顯示……****

Practice 3

> “The evidence ****indicates a change**** in consumer behaviour.”

「證據****顯示****消費者行為出現變化。」

Practice 4

> “Current evidence indicates that the treatment is effective.”

「目前證據**顯示**這種治療有效。」

B. SUGGEST, NOT ALWAYS PROVE

3. **indicate = suggest rather than conclusively prove — 顯示跡象；暗示**

This nuance is very important.

Practice 5

> “The figures **indicate** a possible slowdown.”

「這些數字**顯示**可能出現放緩**。」

Practice 6

> “Her expression indicated that something was wrong.”

「她的表情**顯示**事情有點不對勁。」

indicate often leaves room for uncertainty.

It can be weaker than:

> prove

and sometimes close to:

> suggest.

C. INDICATE SOMETHING

4. **indicate + noun = 顯示某事；表明某情況**

Practice 7

> “The data **indicate strong demand**.”

「數據**顯示需求強勁**。」

Practice 8

> “The survey indicates growing concern.”

「調查**顯示憂慮正在增加**。」

D. INDICATE POSSIBILITY / PROBABILITY

5. **indicate a possibility/trend/problem = 顯示可能性 / 趨勢 / 問題**

Practice 9

> “The figures **indicate a possible problem**.”

「數字**顯示可能存在問題**。」

Practice 10

> “The results indicate an upward trend.”

「結果**顯示上升趨勢**。」

E. SIGN / SYMPTOM

6. **indicate = be a sign of something — 是.....的跡象；顯示.....**

Practice 11

> “A high temperature may **indicate infection**.”

「高體溫可能**顯示有感染**。」

Practice 12

> “Sudden changes may indicate a fault.”

「突然的變化可能**表示系統有故障**。」

indicate = 某現象本身是另一情況的跡象

F. MEDICAL SYMPTOMS

7. **symptom indicates condition = 症狀顯示某疾病 / 病況**

Practice 13

> “Persistent pain may **indicate a deeper problem**.”

「持續疼痛可能**顯示存在更深層問題**。」

Practice 14

> “These symptoms do not necessarily indicate serious illness.”

「這些症狀**不一定表示**有嚴重疾病。」

Important:

> indicate ≠ diagnose

A symptom may indicate something without proving it.

G. POINT OUT / SHOW WHERE

8. **indicate = point to/show the location of something — 指示；指出位置**

A major distinct sense.

Practice 15

> “She **indicated the exit** with her hand.”

「她用手**指示出口的位置**。」

Practice 16

> “The arrow indicates the correct route.”

「箭頭**指示正確路線**。」

indicate = 用手勢、符號、箭頭等指出位置 / 方向

H. INDICATE WITH A GESTURE

9. **indicate with/by a gesture = 用手勢示意**

Practice 17

> “He **indicated with a nod** that I should continue.”

「他點頭**示意**我繼續。」

Practice 18

> “She indicated the chair beside her.”

「她**示意**我坐在旁邊的椅子。」

I. SHOW DIRECTION

10. **indicate direction = 指示方向**

Practice 19

> “The sign **indicates the direction** of the station.”

「標誌**指示車站方向**。」

Practice 20

> “Road markings indicate where drivers should stop.”

「道路標記**指出司機應停車的位置**。」

J. DRIVING: SIGNAL A TURN

11. **indicate = use a vehicle turn signal — 打方向燈；示意轉向**

A very important BrE driving sense.

Practice 21

> “You should **indicate before turning**.”

「轉彎前應該**打方向燈**。」

Practice 22

> “The driver failed to indicate.”

「司機沒有**打方向燈示意**。」

In BrE:

> **indicate** can directly mean use the indicator.

In AmE, people more often say:

> use your turn signal / signal.

K. INDICATOR — CAR

12. **indicator = turn signal — 方向燈**

Especially BrE.

Practice 23

> “He switched on the left **indicator**.”

「他開了左邊的**方向燈**。」

Practice 24

> “The indicator was flashing.”

「方向燈正在**閃爍**。」

Important regional note:

* BrE: **indicator**

* AmE: **turn signal**

L. SHOW ON A DEVICE / INSTRUMENT

13. **indicate = show a value/status on an instrument — 顯示；指示數值 / 狀態**

Practice 25

> “The gauge **indicates the battery level**.”

「儀表**顯示電池電量**。」

Practice 26

> “The display indicates the current temperature.”

「顯示屏**顯示目前溫度**。」

indicate = 儀表 / 裝置把某個狀態或數值顯示出來

M. GAUGE / METER

14. meter indicates + value = 儀表顯示數值

Practice 27

> “The meter **indicated 80% charge**.”

「儀表**顯示電量為 80%**。」

Practice 28

> “The gauge indicates low pressure.”

「儀表**顯示壓力偏低**。」

N. LIGHT / SYMBOL

15. light/symbol indicates status = 燈號 / 符號表示某狀態

Practice 29

> “A green light **indicates that charging is complete**.”

「綠燈**表示充電已完成**。」

Practice 30

> “The symbol indicates a warning.”

「這個符號**表示警告**。」

O. STATE INTENTION

16. **indicate intention/willingness = 表示意向；表明意願**

A major formal sense.

Practice 31

> “Several companies **indicated an interest** in the project.”

「幾間公司**表示有興趣**參與這個項目。」

Practice 32

> “She indicated her willingness to help.”

「她**表示願意**幫忙。」

indicate = 正式或間接表達自己的意向、態度或立場

P. INDICATE THAT YOU WANT / INTEND

17. **indicate that + intention = 表示自己打算.....**

Practice 33

> “He **indicated that he wanted to leave**.”

「他**表示自己想離開**。」

Practice 34

> “The company indicated that it would review the plan.”

「公司**表示會檢討計劃**。」

Here **indicate** is close to:

> state / signal / suggest

depending on directness.

Q. SIGNAL INTEREST

18. **indicate interest = 表示興趣；表明有意**

Practice 35

> “Several buyers **indicated interest** in the property.”

「幾名買家**表示對該物業有興趣**。」

Practice 36

> “Please indicate your interest by Friday.”

「請於星期五前**表明是否有興趣**。」

R. FORM / QUESTIONNAIRE

19. **indicate = specify by selecting/writing — 填寫；註明；選出**

A very useful administrative sense.

Practice 37

> “Please **indicate your preferred date**.”

「請**註明 / 選出你偏好的日期**。」

Practice 38

> “Indicate whether you agree or disagree.”

「請**表明 / 選出**你同意還是不同意。」

indicate = 在表格 / 問卷中明確填出或選擇資訊

S. "PLEASE INDICATE"

20. **please indicate = 請註明；請填寫；請表明**

Common formal instruction.

Practice 39

> "Please **indicate your nationality**."

「請**註明你的國籍**。」

Practice 40

> "Please indicate the number of passengers."

「請**填寫乘客人數**。」

Translation depends on what follows:

* 註明

* 填寫

* 選擇

* 表明

T. INDICATE A PREFERENCE

21. **indicate a preference = 表示偏好**

Practice 41

> "Participants indicated a preference for electric vehicles."

「參加者**表示較偏好電動車**。」

Practice 42

> "Customers were asked to indicate their preferred model."

「顧客被要求**註明自己偏好的型號**。」

U. INDICATE A CHOICE

22. **indicate a choice = 表明 / 選出選擇**

Practice 43

> “Tick one box to **indicate your choice**.”

「請在其中一格打剔，以**表示你的選擇**。」

Practice 44

> “The form requires users to indicate a payment method.”

「表格要求使用者**選擇 / 註明付款方式**。」

V. INDICATE LEVEL / DEGREE

23. **indicate level/degree = 顯示程度 / 水平**

Practice 45

> “The score **indicates the level of risk**.”

「分數**顯示風險程度**。」

Practice 46

> “The colour indicates battery health.”

「顏色**顯示電池健康狀況**。」

W. INDICATOR — GENERAL

24. **indicator = sign/measure showing a condition — 指標；跡象**

A major family noun.

Practice 47

> “Price is not the only **indicator of quality**.”

「價格並不是品質的唯一**指標**。」

Practice 48

> “Customer complaints can be an indicator of a wider problem.”

「客戶投訴可能是更大問題的一個**跡象 / 指標**。」

indicator = 可用來判斷某種狀態、趨勢或結果的事物

X. ECONOMIC INDICATOR

25. **economic indicator = 經濟指標**

Practice 49

> “Unemployment is an important **economic indicator**.”

「失業率是一項重要的**經濟指標**。」

Practice 50

> “Several indicators suggest slower growth.”

「幾項經濟指標顯示增長放緩。」

Y. PERFORMANCE INDICATOR

26. **performance indicator = 績效指標；表現指標**

Practice 51

> “The company tracks several **performance indicators**.”

「公司追蹤多項**績效指標**。」

Practice 52

> “Customer satisfaction is one performance indicator.”

「顧客滿意度是其中一項**表現指標**。」

Z. KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATOR

27. **key performance indicator = 關鍵績效指標**

Often abbreviated:

> KPI

Practice 53

> “Sales growth is a key performance indicator.”

「銷售增長是一項**關鍵績效指標**。」

Practice 54

> “The team reviews its KPIs monthly.”

「團隊每月檢視其**關鍵績效指標**。」

AA. HEALTH INDICATOR

28. **health indicator = 健康指標**

Practice 55

> “Blood pressure is an important health indicator.”

「血壓是一項重要的**健康指標**。」

Practice 56

> “No single indicator gives a complete picture of health.”

「沒有任何單一指標可以完整反映健康狀況。」

AB. ENVIRONMENTAL INDICATOR

29. **environmental indicator = 環境指標**

Practice 57

> “Air quality is an important **environmental indicator**.”

「空氣質素是一項重要的**環境指標**。」

Practice 58

> “The report tracks several environmental indicators.”

「報告追蹤多項**環境指標**。」

AC. LEADING INDICATOR

30. **leading indicator** = 領先指標；先行指標

Business/economics/statistics.

Practice 59

> “New orders can be a **leading indicator** of future demand.”

「新訂單可以成為未來需求的**先行指標**。」

Practice 60

> “Leading indicators may signal change before it appears in headline data.”

「**領先指標**可能在主要數據出現變化前先發出訊號。」

leading indicator = 在較早階段提供未來走勢訊號的指標

AD. LAGGING INDICATOR

31. **lagging indicator** = 落後指標；滯後指標

Practice 61

> “Unemployment is often treated as a **lagging indicator**.”

「失業率經常被視為**滯後指標**。」

Practice 62

> “Lagging indicators confirm changes after they occur.”

「**滯後指標**通常在變化發生後才確認趨勢。」

AE. INDICATION

32. **indication = sign/evidence suggesting something — 跡象；徵兆**

A major noun sense.

Practice 63

> “There is no **indication of a problem**.”

「沒有任何**問題跡象**。」

Practice 64

> “The rise in sales is an indication of stronger demand.”

「銷售上升是需求增強的一個**跡象**。」

indication = 顯示某情況存在 / 可能存在的訊號或證據

AF. “AN INDICATION THAT...”

33. **an indication that + clause =的一個跡象**

Practice 65

> “This is an **indication that confidence is returning**.”

「這是一個**顯示信心正在恢復的跡象**。」

Practice 66

> “The delay may be an indication that something is wrong.”

「延誤可能是一個**顯示有問題的跡象**。」

AG. “NO INDICATION”

34. **no indication = 沒有跡象；沒有顯示**

Practice 67

> “There was **no indication** of damage.”

「沒有任何**損壞跡象**。」

Practice 68

> “There is no indication that prices will fall.”

「沒有跡象**顯示價格會下降**。」

AH. “EVERY INDICATION”

35. **every indication = 所有跡象都.....；種種跡象**

Practice 69

> “There is **every indication that** demand will continue to grow.”

「**種種跡象都顯示**需求會繼續增長。」

Practice 70

> “By every indication, the project is on schedule.”

「從所有跡象來看，項目正按進度進行。」

AI. GIVE AN INDICATION

36. **give an indication of = 顯示；讓人了解大概情況**

Practice 71

> “The survey gives an **indication of public opinion**.”

「調查讓我們**大致了解公眾意見**。」

Practice 72

> “These figures give an indication of future demand.”

「這些數字可以**反映未來需求的大概情況**。」

Here **indication** can mean:

> rough idea / approximate signal.

AJ. ROUGH INDICATION

37. **rough indication = 粗略概況；大概指標**

Practice 73

> “The figures provide only a **rough indication** of cost.”

「這些數字只能提供成本的**粗略概況**。」

Practice 74

> “The test gives a rough indication of battery health.”

「這項測試只能**大概反映電池健康狀況**。」

Important nuance:

> indication may be approximate rather than exact.

AK. INDICATION OF INTENTION

38. **indication = sign/expression of intention — 意向表示；表示**

Practice 75

> “The announcement was the first **indication of a change in policy**.”

「這項宣布是政策將有改變的第一個**跡象**。」

Practice 76

> “He gave no indication that he intended to resign.”

「他沒有任何**表示 / 跡象**顯示打算辭職。」

AL. MEDICAL INDICATION

39. **indication = medical reason for using a treatment — 適應症；使用某治療的醫療理由**

A major specialist sense.

Practice 77

> “The drug has several approved **indications**.”

「這種藥物有幾項獲批准的**適應症**。」

Practice 78

> “Pain relief is one indication for this treatment.”

「止痛是這項治療的一項**適應症 / 使用理由**。」

medical indication = 有足夠醫療理由使用某藥物、檢查或治療的病況 / 情況

This is genuinely distinct from “sign”.

AM. INDICATED — MEDICAL

40. **be indicated = medically appropriate/recommended — 有適應症的；醫學上適宜的**

Practice 79

> “Surgery is **not indicated** in this case.”

「這個個案**並不適宜進行手術 / 沒有手術適應症**。」

Practice 80

> “Further testing may be indicated.”

「可能**有需要進一步檢查**。」

****indicated — medicine = 根據病情，某治療 / 檢查屬適當或有理由採用****

AN. CONTRAINDICATED

41. **contraindicated = 禁忌的；不適宜使用的**

Important family extension.

Practice 81

> “The medication is ****contraindicated**** during pregnancy.”

「這種藥物在懷孕期間屬****禁忌 / 不宜使用****。」

Practice 82

> “The treatment may be contraindicated in certain patients.”

「某些病人可能****不適合接受這種治療****。」

This is a high-value medical family extension.

AO. INDICATIVE

42. **indicative of = 顯示.....的；表明.....的**

A major adjective.

Practice 83

> “The results are ****indicative of stronger demand****.”

「結果****顯示需求正在增強****。」

Practice 84

> “His silence was indicative of discomfort.”

「他的沉默****顯示他感到不自在****。」

****indicative of X = 可被視為 X 的跡象 / 證據****

AP. "NOT NECESSARILY INDICATIVE OF"

43. **not necessarily indicative of = 不一定表示.....**

Practice 85

> "A high view count is **not necessarily indicative of popularity**."

「高觀看數**不一定代表受歡迎程度高**。」

Practice 86

> "One bad result is not necessarily indicative of a wider problem."

「一次差的結果**不一定表示存在更大問題**。」

Excellent academic phrase.

AQ. INDICATIVE MOOD — GRAMMAR

44. **the indicative = 直陳語氣**

A genuinely distinct grammatical sense.

Practice 87

> "The sentence is in the **indicative mood**."

「這個句子使用**直陳語氣**。」

Practice 88

> "The indicative is typically used for statements presented as facts."

「**直陳語氣**通常用來表達被當作事實陳述的內容。」

indicative mood = 用來陳述事實、資訊或被視為真實情況的語法語氣

Contrasts with:

* subjunctive

* imperative

AR. INDICATIVE VS INDICATOR

45. **indicative vs indicator**

indicative

= adjective meaning “showing/suggesting”.

indicator

= noun meaning “measure/sign/device”.

> indicative of risk

> = 顯示有風險

> risk indicator

> = 風險指標

AS. INDICATOR — DEVICE

46. **indicator = device/display showing status — 指示器；顯示器**

Practice 89

> “The battery **indicator** turned red.”

「電池**指示器**變成紅色。」

Practice 90

> “The indicator shows whether the charger is working.”

「指示器顯示充電器是否正在運作。」

AT. STATUS INDICATOR

47. **status indicator = 狀態指示器 / 狀態指標**

Practice 91

> “A light serves as a **status indicator**.”

「一盞燈用作**狀態指示器**。」

Practice 92

> “The status indicator shows whether the system is online.”

「狀態指示器顯示系統是否在線。」

AU. PROGRESS INDICATOR

48. **progress indicator** = 進度指示器

Practice 93

> “The app displays a **progress indicator**.”

「應用程式顯示一個**進度指示器**。」

Practice 94

> “A progress bar is one type of progress indicator.”

「進度條是一種**進度指示器**。」

AV. INDICATOR LIGHT

49. **indicator light** = 指示燈

Practice 95

> “The **indicator light** turns green when charging is complete.”

「充電完成時，**指示燈**會變綠。」

Practice 96

> “A flashing indicator light signals a fault.”

「閃爍的**指示燈**表示有故障。」

AW. INDICATE IN MAPS / DIAGRAMS

50. **indicate = represent/show by a mark, colour or symbol — 以標記 / 顏色表示**

Practice 97

> “Red lines **indicate major roads**.”

「紅線**表示主要道路**。」

Practice 98

> “The shaded area indicates the charging zone.”

「陰影部分**表示充電區域**。」

AX. INDICATE ON A CHART

51. **indicate = show information graphically — 圖表上顯示**

Practice 99

> “The chart indicates a steady rise in sales.”

「圖表**顯示銷售穩步上升**。」

Practice 100

> “The dotted line indicates the target level.”

「虛線**表示目標水平**。」

AY. INDICATE TIME / DATE

52. **indicate = display/specify time, date, amount, etc. — 顯示 / 註明**

Practice 101

> “The ticket **indicates the departure time**.”

「車票**註明出發時間**。」

Practice 102

> “The label indicates the expiry date.”

「標籤上**註明有效期限**。」

Here Chinese often becomes:

> 註明

rather than:

> 顯示.

AZ. INDICATE PRICE / AMOUNT

53. **indicate = specify a stated amount — 註明；列明**

Practice 103

> “The invoice **indicates the total amount**.”

「發票**列明總金額**。」

Practice 104

> “The website indicates the estimated charging cost.”

「網站**列明估計充電成本**。」

BA. INDICATE A NEED

54. **indicate a need for = 顯示有.....的需要**

Practice 105

> “The results **indicate a need for further research**.”

「結果****顯示有需要進一步研究****。」

Practice 106

> “Frequent failures indicate a need for maintenance.”

「頻繁故障****顯示需要維修****。」

Very common academic/professional phrase.

BB. INDICATE IMPORTANCE

55. ****indicate importance/priority = 表明重要性 / 優先級****

Practice 107

> “The ranking indicates each task’s priority.”

「排名****顯示每項工作的優先級****。」

Practice 108

> “Bold type indicates important information.”

「粗體****表示重要資訊****。」

BC. INDICATE RELATIONSHIP

56. ****indicate a relationship/correlation = 顯示關係 / 相關性****

Practice 109

> “The data indicate a relationship between cost and demand.”

「數據****顯示成本與需求之間存在關係****。」

Practice 110

> “Correlation does not necessarily indicate causation.”

「相關性****不一定表示因果關係****。」

Excellent academic phrase.

BD. "INDICATE CAUSATION" — CAUTION

57. **indicate causation ≠ prove causation**

Evidence can:

> indicate a possible causal relationship

without:

> proving it conclusively.

So:

> indicate = 支持 / 顯示可能性

> prove = 證明

Important academic distinction.

BE. INDICATE VS SHOW

58. **indicate vs show**

show

= broad everyday verb: make something visible/evident.

indicate

= more formal; often means evidence/signs suggest something.

Compare:

> "The screen shows the battery level."

> = 螢幕顯示電量。

> "The data indicate falling demand."

> = 數據顯示需求下降。

Indicate is especially common in:

- * research
- * data
- * formal writing
- * signs
- * instruments

BF. INDICATE VS SUGGEST

59. **indicate vs suggest**

suggest

= point toward a possibility.

indicate

= provide a somewhat clearer sign/evidence.

Very roughly:

> suggest → 暗示 / 顯示可能

> indicate → 顯示 / 表明

But the strength overlaps heavily depending on context.

BG. INDICATE VS PROVE

60. **indicate vs prove**

indicate

= evidence points toward conclusion.

prove

= establish conclusion decisively.

Your passage says:

> research indicates that...

This is appropriately cautious academic wording.

It does ****not necessarily mean****:

> research proves beyond all doubt that...

BH. INDICATE VS DEMONSTRATE

61. ****indicate vs demonstrate****

****indicate****

= evidence suggests/shows.

****demonstrate****

= show more clearly/convincingly, often with stronger evidence.

> results indicate an association

> experiment demonstrates an effect

Though actual strength depends on discipline/context.

BI. INDICATE VS REVEAL

62. ****indicate vs reveal****

****indicate****

= point to/signify.

****reveal****

= make previously hidden information known.

> data indicate a trend

> = 數據顯示趨勢

> investigation reveals fraud

> = 調查揭露欺詐

BJ. INDICATE VS SIGNIFY

63. **indicate vs signify**

indicate

= show/point to.

signify

= mean/represent, often symbolically or formally.

> flashing light indicates a fault

> = 閃燈顯示故障

> white may signify peace

> = 白色可象徵和平

BK. INDICATE VS SIGNAL

64. **indicate vs signal**

indicate

= show/provide evidence.

signal

= actively send a sign/message, or be a strong sign of change.

> data indicate slowing demand

> rate cut signals policy change

signal often feels more active/deliberate.

BL. INDICATE VS POINT TO

65. **indicate vs point to**

point to

= suggest/show evidence of something.

indicate

= more formal equivalent in many analytical contexts.

> symptoms point to infection

> symptoms indicate infection

Very close.

BM. INDICATE VS STATE

66. **indicate vs state**

state

= say something explicitly/directly.

indicate

= may be indirect.

Example:

> "He stated that he would resign."

> = 他明確表示會辭職。

> "He indicated that he might resign."

> = 他表示 / 暗示自己可能辭職。

State is more explicit.

BN. INDICATE VS MENTION

mention

= refer to something briefly.

indicate

= show/specify information.

> mention a concern

> = 提到一項憂慮

> indicate your preference

> = 表明你的偏好

Different functions.

BO. INDICATE VS SPECIFY

67. **indicate vs specify**

indicate

= show/mark/give information.

specify

= state precisely and explicitly.

> indicate preferred time

> = 註明偏好時間

> specify exact time

> = 明確列出確實時間

Specify is more precise.

BP. INDICATE VS POINT

point

= physically direct with finger/object.

indicate

= broader:

* point physically

* show with symbol

* show with evidence

* express intention

So:

> indicate is semantically broader.

BQ. INDICATOR VS SIGN

68. **indicator vs sign**

sign

= any evidence/symptom suggesting something.

indicator

= often something deliberately used to measure/assess a condition.

> cough = sign of illness

> infection rate = health indicator

But overlap exists.

BR. INDICATOR VS MEASURE

69. **indicator vs measure**

indicator

= suggests or represents condition.

measure

= quantifies it directly or operationally.

Example:

> customer complaints may be an indicator of dissatisfaction

> satisfaction score is a measure of reported satisfaction

Not always sharply separated, but useful analytically.

BS. INDICATOR VS METRIC

70. **indicator vs metric**

metric

= quantitative measurement.

indicator

= can be quantitative or qualitative and points to a broader condition.

> conversion rate = metric

> falling conversion rate = indicator of weaker demand

BT. INDICATOR VS PREDICTOR

You previously curated **predictor** under **unpredictable**.

indicator

= tells us about a current/past condition.

predictor

= helps forecast a future outcome.

One variable can function as both.

Example:

> current sales = indicator of present demand

> advance orders = predictor of future demand

BU. INDICATIVE VS SUGGESTIVE

71. **indicative vs suggestive**

indicative of X

= evidence pointing to X.

suggestive of X

= resembles/supports X, often more tentative.

> results indicative of improvement

> = 結果顯示改善

> symptoms suggestive of infection

> = 症狀提示可能感染

In medicine, **suggestive of** may deliberately sound tentative.

BV. INDICATIVE VS REPRESENTATIVE

indicative

= provides evidence/sign.

representative

= typical of a larger whole.

A small sample may be:

> indicative of a trend

without being:

> representative of the whole population.

Excellent research distinction.

BW. INDICATIVE VS CONCLUSIVE

indicative

= points toward conclusion.

conclusive

= decisive enough to settle conclusion.

> indicative evidence

> = 指向某結論的證據

> conclusive evidence

> = 決定性 / 確鑿證據

BX. INDICATION VS PROOF

indication

= sign/evidence suggesting.

proof

= evidence establishing conclusively.

> “There are indications of fraud.”

does not equal:

> “There is proof of fraud.”

Very important.

BY. INDICATION VS EVIDENCE

evidence

= information/facts supporting conclusion.

indication

= a sign arising from that evidence.

Evidence can provide:

> an indication.

BZ. INDICATION VS WARNING

indication

= neutral sign.

warning

= sign/message specifically alerting to danger/problem.

> rising temperature = indication

> alarm = warning

CA. INDICATION VS SYMPTOM

symptom

= experienced/observed manifestation of illness/problem.

indication

= broader sign suggesting a condition.

A symptom can be an indication of disease.

CB. INDICATION VS INTENTION

indication of intention

= sign that someone plans something.

intention

= actual plan/aim itself.

> no indication of resigning

> does not necessarily mean

> no intention of resigning.

They may simply not have shown it.

CC. INDICATIVE MOOD VS INDICATIVE OF

Important grammatical distinction:

indicative of

= 顯示.....的

indicative mood

= 直陳語氣

Same adjective family, very different domain.

CD. INDICATOR IN YOUR PASSAGE CONTEXT

Although the noun **indicator** does not occur, the passage contains many things that could function as indicators:

- * purchase price
- * battery condition
- * resale value
- * charging availability
- * sales figures

For example:

> “Low sales can be an indicator of limited consumer confidence.”

「低銷量可以是消費者信心不足的一個**指標**。」

This helps distinguish the family:

- > **indicate** = verb
- > **indication** = sign
- > **indicator** = sign/measure/device

CE. PRONUNCIATION / STRESS

indicate /'ɪndɪkeɪt/

indication /,ɪndɪ'keɪʃən/

****indicator**** /'ɪndɪkeɪtə(r)/

****indicative**** /ɪn'dɪkətɪv/

Important stress shift:

> ****IN**dicat**e

> **indi**CA**tion**

> ****IN**dicat**or

> **in**DI**cat**ive

Useful pronunciation-family note.

CF. FAMILY-EXTENSION SWEEP

Following the fullest-reference style, the useful modern inventory includes:

* ****indicate that**** = 顯示 / 表明.....

* ****indicate + noun**** = 顯示某狀況

* ****evidence indicates**** = 證據顯示

* ****data indicate**** = 數據顯示

* ****indicate a trend**** = 顯示趨勢

* ****indicate a problem**** = 顯示問題

* ****indicate infection**** = 顯示可能感染

* ****indicate location**** = 指出位置

* ****indicate direction**** = 指示方向

* ****indicate with a gesture**** = 用手勢示意

* ****indicate before turning**** = 轉彎前打方向燈

* ****indicator — vehicle**** = 方向燈

* ****indicate a value/status**** = 顯示數值 / 狀態

* ****indicate willingness**** = 表示意願

* ****indicate intention**** = 表示意圖

* ****indicate interest**** = 表示興趣

* ****indicate preference**** = 表示偏好

* ****please indicate**** = 請註明 / 填寫 / 表明

* ****indicator — general**** = 指標 / 跡象

* ****economic indicator**** = 經濟指標

* ****performance indicator**** = 績效指標

* ****key performance indicator**** = 關鍵績效指標

* ****health indicator**** = 健康指標

* ****environmental indicator**** = 環境指標

* ****leading indicator**** = 先行指標

* ****lagging indicator**** = 滯後指標

* ****indicator light**** = 指示燈

* ****status indicator**** = 狀態指示器

* **progress indicator** = 進度指示器
 * **indication** = 跡象 / 徵兆
 * **an indication that** = 顯示.....的跡象
 * **no indication** = 沒有跡象
 * **every indication** = 種種跡象
 * **rough indication** = 粗略概況
 * **medical indication** = 適應症
 * **be indicated — medical** = 醫學上適宜 / 有需要
 * **contraindicated** = 禁忌 / 不適宜使用的
 * **indicative of** = 顯示.....的
 * **not necessarily indicative of** = 不一定表示.....
 * **indicative mood** = 直陳語氣

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
indicate — evidence	證據、結果或跡象顯示某結論可能 / 很可能成立
indicate that	表明 / 顯示後面的陳述得到某種證據支持
indicate — sign	某現象本身構成另一情況存在的跡象
indicate — point/show location	以手勢、箭頭、符號等指出位置或方向
indicate — driving	使用車輛方向燈示意轉彎 / 轉線
indicate — instrument	儀表、裝置或畫面顯示某數值 / 狀態
indicate — intention	以直接或間接方式表示自己的意向、態度或意願
indicate — form/instruction	在表格 / 問卷中註明、填寫或選出指定資訊
indicator — general	用來反映某狀況、趨勢或表現的指標 / 跡象
indicator — vehicle	車輛用來示意轉向的方向燈
indicator — device	顯示設備狀態 / 數值的指示器
leading indicator	在較早階段反映未來可能走勢的指標
lagging indicator	在變化發生後才反映 / 確認趨勢的指標
indication — sign	顯示某情況存在或可能存在的跡象
rough indication	只能提供大概情況、而非精確結果的資訊
medical indication	使用某藥物、檢查或治療的醫療理由 / 適應症
be indicated — medical	根據病情判斷，某檢查 / 治療屬適宜或有需要
contraindicated	因安全 / 病情原因不適宜使用的
indicative of	可被視為某情況的跡象 / 證據
indicative mood	用來陳述事實、資訊或被視為真實情況的直陳語氣

For your original sentence

> “Although research ****indicates that**** electric vehicles are greener than petrol cars...”

The exact meaning is:

****indicates = 研究證據 / 結果顯示「電動車較汽油車環保」這個結論得到支持；語氣比 prove 較審慎，不一定表示已經毫無疑問地證明。 ****

Natural translation:

> ****「雖然研究顯示，電動車比汽油車更環保.....」 ****

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****indicate that**** → 證據顯示 / 表明.....
- > ****indicate a problem**** → 顯示有問題
- > ****indicate direction**** → 指示方向
- > ****indicate before turning**** → 打方向燈
- > ****indicate a preference**** → 表明偏好
- > ****please indicate**** → 請註明 / 填寫
- > ****indicator**** → 指標 / 指示器 / 方向燈
- > ****indication**** → 跡象 / 徵兆
- > ****medical indication**** → 適應症
- > ****indicative of**** → 顯示.....的
- > ****indicative mood**** → 直陳語氣
- > ****indicate ≠ prove**** → 顯示證據支持 ≠ 決定性證明
- > ****indicate ≠ state**** → 可間接顯示 / 表示 ≠ 明確陳述
- > ****indicator ≠ predictor**** → 反映狀況的指標 ≠ 用來預測未來的因子